

Current Programme

Gesualdo / Take 6 - vocal harmony without voices

Format

Start: 20:30. Nominal music duration: about 29:30. Realistic performed music duration: about 32-33 minutes. With transitions and short spoken islands: about 41-42 minutes. Spoken introduction and discussion: about 18-20 minutes. Total event: about 59-62 minutes.

Concept

The evening begins with a short four-voice piece played without a composer label. The audience can first hear it as a question: Renaissance, Baroque, sacred, modern? The reveal - the Beach Boys' Our Prayer - opens the central idea of the concert: vocal harmony can migrate into the string quartet and still keep its harmonic identity.

From there the programme moves to Gesualdo, where five- and six-voice vocal writing creates a harder reduction problem, and then to Take 6, whose close-harmony language becomes a modern mirror.

Programme

#	Piece	Source	Time	Function
1	<i>Anonymous opening chorale</i> revealed later as The Beach Boys, Our Prayer	4 voices	1:08	Short opening question
2	Carlo Gesualdo, <i>Luci serene e chiare</i>	5 voices	2:59	Opening Gesualdo example
3	Carlo Gesualdo, <i>Dolcissima mia vita</i>	5 voices	2:15	Short lyrical madrigal
4	Carlo Gesualdo, <i>Gia piansi nel dolore</i>	5 voices	2:37	Chromatic expression of grief
5	Carlo Gesualdo, <i>S'io non miro non moro</i>	5 voices	2:00	Compact madrigal; Mantovani link
6	Take 6, <i>Come Unto Me</i>	6 vocal parts	2:13	First Take 6 comparison
7	Carlo Gesualdo, <i>Moro, lasso, al mio duolo</i>	5 voices	2:58	Central Gesualdo example
8	Carlo Gesualdo, <i>Sparge la morte</i>	5 voices	2:49	Contrasting madrigal texture
9	Carlo Gesualdo, <i>Belta, poi che t'assenti</i>	5 voices	2:11	Stravinsky connection
10	Carlo Gesualdo, <i>Tristis est anima mea</i>	6 voices	3:00	Six-voice sacred work
11	Take 6, <i>Hark! The Herald Angels Sing</i>	6 vocal parts	2:32	Bright late-program contrast
12	Take 6, <i>A Quiet Place</i>	6 vocal parts	2:46	Final calm piece

Dramatic Shape

Prologue - anonymous four-part harmony, then the Beach Boys reveal.

Arc I - Gesualdo madrigal language: light, sweetness, grief, paradox.

Arc II - Take 6 as modern mirror, then the central Gesualdo shock of Moro, lasso.

Arc III - six-voice sacred darkness, bright Take 6 radiance, and the quiet close of A Quiet Place.

Spoken Structure

1. One-minute opening invitation: listen first without a label.
2. Reveal Our Prayer and introduce vocal music without voices.
3. Explain the madrigal and Gesualdo's chromatic voice-leading.
4. Introduce Take 6 as a modern close-harmony mirror.
5. Explain the AI reduction problem as a balance of competing musical constraints.
6. Prepare the final sequence: sacred darkness, radiance, repose.